

Digital guide on breaking dating app addiction while still finding meaningful connections — Action Checklist

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TRACK YOUR TRIGGERS

- ☐ **Track Your Triggers:** Document every time you open a dating app for seven consecutive days, recording the exact time, what you were doing before, how you felt, what you expected, and what actually happened so you can see real patterns instead of vague impressions.
- ☐ **Track Your Triggers:** Review your seven-day log and identify your three most frequent triggers by frequency, noting which ones pull you back to the app repeatedly and deserve the most attention.
- ☐ **Track Your Triggers:** Look for patterns like the After-Work Void, the Late-Night Spiral, the Post-Rejection Recovery, the Bored Anchoring, and the Saturday Night FOMO to understand when and why your hand reaches for your phone.
- ☐ **Track Your Triggers:** Name your specific triggers clearly in your log, such as "10pm in bed can't sleep" or "6:30pm home alone after work," so you can design targeted solutions instead of vague intentions.

DESIGN YOUR EXITS

- ☐ **Design Your Exits:** Create a specific interruption for each of your top three triggers using the formula "When [TRIGGER] happens, I will [SPECIFIC ALTERNATIVE BEHAVIOR] instead," making the alternative concrete and actionable.
- ☐ **Design Your Exits:** Choose physical interruption tactics for your highest-frequency triggers, such as putting your phone across the room or deleting the app entirely, so you can't act on autopilot.
- ☐ **Design Your Exits:** Replace the app with a specific alternative activity for each trigger time, like calling a friend at 10pm instead of swiping, so you have a ready-made substitute when the urge hits.
- ☐ **Design Your Exits:** Test your interruption strategies during actual trigger moments to confirm they work, and revise any that don't hold up after a few attempts.

REPLACE THE APP

- ☐ **Replace the App:** Delete the dating app from your phone, log out permanently, or move it to a folder you can't easily access so the app is no longer a reflexive option at your most vulnerable moments.
 - ☐ **Replace the App:** Schedule at least one in-person social activity per week with friends, acquaintances, or people in your community to practice real-world connection and rebuild social confidence without a swipe interface.
 - ☐ **Replace the App:** Initiate conversations with strangers in everyday settings like coffee shops, bookstores, gyms, or fitness classes, using genuine curiosity about them as your opening rather than a bio or a like button.
 - ☐ **Replace the App:** Reframe your exhaustion and hopelessness as evidence that the app is failing you, not that you are failing at dating, so you can separate your self-worth from your current outcomes.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.